

2d. Content of non-exam assessment in A Level in English Language: Independent language research (Component 03)

Independent language research (Component 03) comprises two sections. Section A, An independent investigation of language, provides learners with the opportunity to pursue an area of study which is of particular personal interest. Section B, The academic poster, allows learners to present their research from their independent investigation in a concise and visually accessible way.

In Section B, only the poster will be assessed in this section. However, the 'real-world' purpose of the academic poster is for use in conferences and to present research projects to a group of peers. This piece of work therefore provides an excellent opportunity for learners to present their research to each other, and could also be used to give the next year's cohort an insight into the types of investigation that have been undertaken, in order to stimulate their thinking. This provides excellent preparation for the types of activities undertaken in universities as a means to disseminate current research findings.

The task title for Component 03, Independent language research, should be chosen by the learner in discussion with their teacher but all task titles must be checked by OCR. Centres **must** use the *Task Titles Proposal Form* to submit all chosen task titles to OCR for approval.

You can access the *Task Titles Proposal Form* through the OCR website (see also Appendix 5d). Centres must submit their *Task Titles Proposal Form* every series even if the task titles have been approved previously. There is no restriction on the number of learners choosing the same topic for their investigation. However, there is no limit to the range of topics appropriate for an independent investigation, and individuality of approach is in the spirit of the specification.

OCR will confirm to the centres that appropriate task titles have been chosen. It is the centre's responsibility to ensure that the task titles **for all learners** are acknowledged in the *Task Titles Proposal Form*.

OCR consultants may contact centres requesting further information in order to be able to confirm the appropriateness of the task title(s). Centres are advised to wait until they have received confirmation from OCR that the chosen task titles are suitable before learners begin working on the tasks.

More information about the deadlines for submitting the form and expected turnaround times can be found on the OCR website: www.ocr.org.uk.